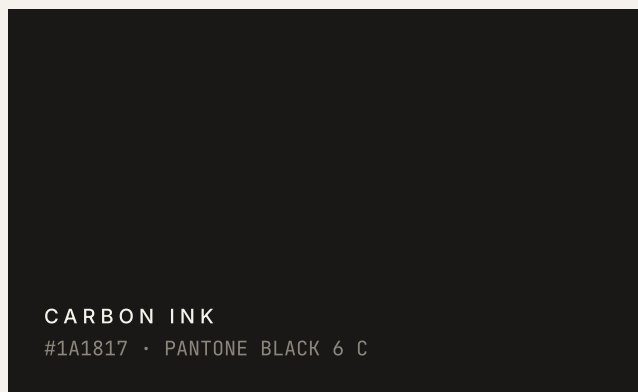


# The Color System

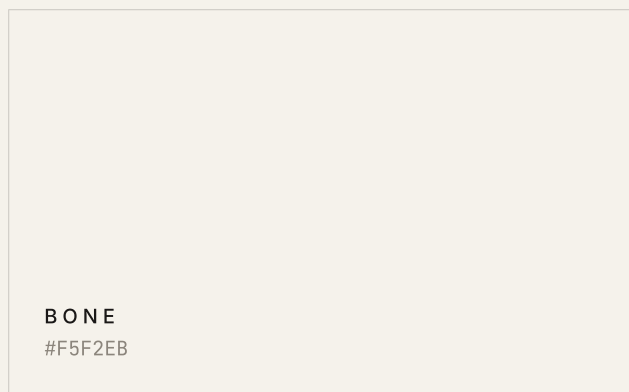
*Foundation, accent, hierarchy. The disciplined chromatic identity of Hemanth Lal.*

## 01 — FOUNDATION

*The two surfaces the brand lives on. Every other color is placed in relation to these.*



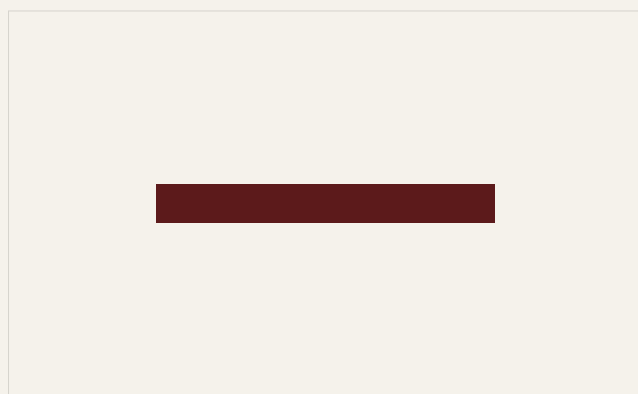
*Primary dark. Body text. Authoritative surface for hero moments, dark presentation slides, foil-stamped print.*



*Primary light. Default working surface. Web, social, body of decks, long-form essays, all standard print collateral.*

## 02 — BRAND ACCENT — OXBLOOD

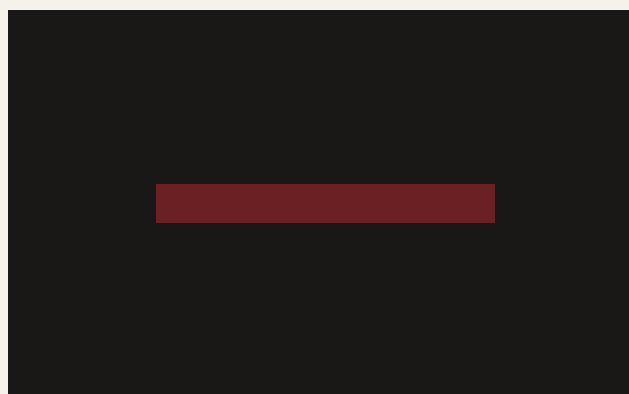
*The single chromatic identity of the brand. Same color, expressed in two registers calibrated for surface.*



### OXBLOOD

#5C1A1B

*Primary brand register. On Bone surfaces.*



### LIFTED OXBLOOD

#6B2024

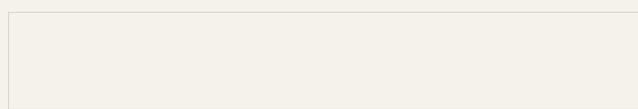
*Companion register. On Carbon Ink surfaces.*

#### WHERE OXBLOOD APPEARS

- Section labels and small caps headers
- Brand rules and accent dividers
- Foil stamping on premium print
- Single emphasized word per surface
- Essay number marks and edition tags
- Monogram on business card back

## 03 — UTILITY ACCENT — GRAPHITE BLUE

*Functional only. Never a brand color. Reserved for moments where chromatic differentiation is required and Oxblood would over-claim emphasis.*

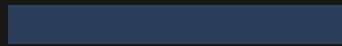




## GRAPHITE BLUE

#243248

Utility — light surfaces.



## LIFTED GRAPHITE

#2B3E5C

Utility — dark surfaces.

### WHERE GRAPHITE BLUE APPEARS

- Secondary data series in charts
- Secondary CTAs and link underlines
- Hyperlinks in long-form essays
- Footnote numerals and reference marks

## 04 — TONAL HIERARCHY

Functional neutrals. Carry hierarchy and texture without introducing chromatic competition.



### SMOKE INK

#3F3D3A

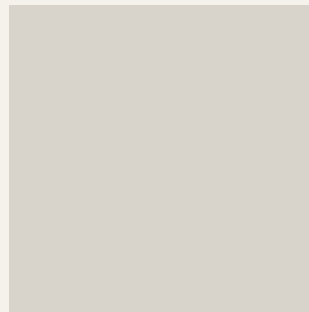
Subheads, secondary text, italic clarifications.



### STONE GRAY

#8B857C

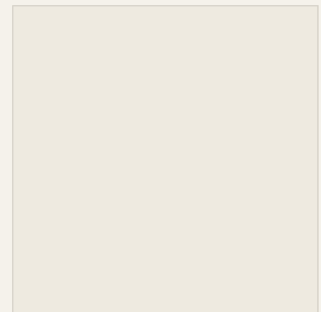
Captions, metadata, slide numbers, quiet UI.



### ASH LINE

#D8D4CB

Hairline rules, subtle dividers, table borders.



### PAPER CREAM

#EEEE00

Sidebars, secondary surfaces, callout backgrounds.

## 05 — USAGE RATIOS

The proportion each color occupies on a typical brand surface. Discipline is in the restraint.

BONE — 70%

CARBON INK — 22%

BONE 70% CARBON INK 22% SMOKE INK 5% OXBLOOD 2% GRAPHITE 1%

A typical Bone-dominant surface — essay page, social post, letterhead — holds these proportions. Oxblood appears in roughly 2% of the visual area. That is the discipline. More than 5% accent on any single surface, and the brand begins to read as decorated rather than considered.

## 06 — OPERATING RULES

- 01 Maximum three colors per surface. Default to two. Foundation always present. Accent earns its place.
- 02 Oxblood is the brand's chromatic identity. Lifted Oxblood is the same identity rendered for dark surfaces — never used together on one surface.
- 03 Graphite Blue is utility, not brand. It appears only where chromatic differentiation is functionally required — data, hyperlinks, secondary UI.
- 04 Pure black (#000000) and pure white (#FFFFFF) are forbidden. Use Carbon Ink and Bone instead. The warmth is the brand.
- 05 Tonal neutrals carry hierarchy. When a third dark tone is needed, reach for Smoke Ink before reaching for color.

## 07 — SYSTEM IN APPLICATION

The system holding across two of the most repeated brand surfaces — a social post on Bone, and a presentation slide cover on Carbon Ink.

## PRINCIPLE 03

**A brand that tries to speak to everyone becomes valuable to no one.**

*Specificity is not a limitation. It is the source of pricing power, loyalty, and market gravity.*

**Hemanth Lal**  
STRATEGIC CONSULTANT

№ 03 / 12

SOCIAL POST — INSTAGRAM 1:1

DECK 02 — STRATEGIC  
POSITIONING

FOR CONFIDENTIAL  
REVIEW

*A strategic positioning proposal for —*

# The Considered Brand in a Crowded Category.

**Hemanth Lal**  
STRATEGIC CONSULTANT

NOVEMBER 2026 CHAPTER 01

PRESENTATION COVER — 16:9